



FINDINGS APPENDIX · DXC ADVISORYX

MeridianFS Holdings, Inc.

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Methodology · Opportunity map (value vs difficulty) · Dimension-by-dimension detail (six) · Sources and acknowledgments

METHODOLOGY

This assessment scores six AI-readiness dimensions on a 0-100 scale from a structured questionnaire, weighting each question by its diagnostic value. Tiers are Emerging (0-39), Developing (40-59), Established (60-79), Leading (80-100). Where available, public research signals adjust the questionnaire-derived score. Regulatory Complexity is informational and indicates constraint, not opportunity. A DXC senior partner reviews and approves the output before delivery.

OPPORTUNITY MAP — VALUE vs DIFFICULTY



DATA FOUNDATION — 51/100 · Developing

What this captures. Whether data is integrated, current, accessible to AI, and trusted enough to build on.

Your score. Questionnaire-derived score (weighted by question diagnostic value).

Questionnaire signals.

- Q1.1: Where does your enterprise's operational data primarily live? → Several major systems with documented but partial integration (score 40)
- Q1.2: What proportion of significant business decisions today are made with current, accurate data? → Most operational decisions have current data; strategic decisions lag (score 55)
- Q1.3: How readily can data be accessed and prepared for AI applications? → A data platform exists that supports most AI use cases with moderate effort (score 70)
- Q1.4: How would your team describe the current quality of operational data? → Quality issues acknowledged; ad hoc remediation efforts (score 40)

Research signals. No external research signals.

Peer comparison. Peer benchmarks are introduced in V0.5+ (placeholder).

What strong looks like. A unified, governed data layer where AI teams self-serve clean data through APIs and feature stores.

Actions to improve.

- Prioritize the data domains behind your top use cases
- Stand up governance and clear ownership for those domains
- Expose curated, reusable datasets to AI teams

GOVERNANCE POSTURE — 38/100 · Emerging

What this captures. Whether AI governance, risk ownership, and regulatory interpretation are operationalized, not just drafted.

Your score. Questionnaire-derived score (weighted by question diagnostic value).

Questionnaire signals.

- Q2.1: Does your organization have a defined AI governance framework? → Draft AI principles exist but not operationalized (score 35)
- Q2.2: Who owns AI-related risk decisions in your organization today? → Distributed across CISO, Compliance, Legal with informal coordination (score 35)
- Q2.3: How is your organization interpreting industry-specific AI regulatory guidance? → Active legal and compliance review underway (score 45)

Research signals. No external research signals.

Peer comparison. Peer benchmarks are introduced in V0.5+ (placeholder).

What strong looks like. A mature framework with risk tiering, a clear AI risk owner, monitoring, and board oversight.

Actions to improve.

- Name an accountable AI risk owner with a cross-functional committee
- Move from principles to operational review gates
- Operationalize industry AI guidance into controls

AI INVESTMENT MATURITY — 61/100 · Established

What this captures. How much AI has moved from pilots to production value, and the trajectory of investment.

Your score. Questionnaire-derived score (weighted by question diagnostic value).

Questionnaire signals.

- Q3.1: How many distinct AI initiatives has your organization launched in the last 24 months? → 6-15 initiatives at various stages; some in production (score 70)
- Q3.2: What AI applications are in production today, generating measurable business value? → Several production applications with measurable value (score 70)
- Q3.3: How would you describe the business outcomes from AI investment to date? → Some efficiency gains documented; broader impact unclear (score 45)
- Q3.4: How is AI investment trending in your organization for the coming year? → Holding flat while we evaluate what has worked (score 50)

Research signals. No external research signals.

Peer comparison. Peer benchmarks are introduced in V0.5+ (placeholder).

What strong looks like. Multiple production AI applications with measurable, attributable business value and portfolio governance.

Actions to improve.

- Define value pockets at scoping to lift production conversion
- Instrument outcomes so ROI is attributable
- Govern the initiative portfolio rather than funding ad hoc pilots

ORGANIZATIONAL CHANGE READINESS — 53/100 · Developing

What this captures. Leadership alignment, change-management capacity, and workforce posture toward AI.

Your score. Questionnaire-derived score (weighted by question diagnostic value).

Questionnaire signals.

- Q4.1: How does your organization typically respond to major operational changes? → Resistance is expected and managed; changes generally land on time (score 50)
- Q4.2: How aligned is the senior leadership team on AI ambition and approach? → Leadership broadly supportive; specifics still being shaped (score 55)
- Q4.3: How is your workforce engaging with AI as a topic today? → Mixed posture; some teams enthusiastic, others apprehensive (score 55)

Research signals. No external research signals.

Peer comparison. Peer benchmarks are introduced in V0.5+ (placeholder).

What strong looks like. Aligned leadership, strong change muscle, and a workforce helping shape AI adoption.

Actions to improve.

- Align leadership on a single AI ambition and targets
- Invest change-management capacity ahead of scaling
- Engage the workforce as participants, not subjects

VALUE-POCKET CLARITY — 46/100 · Developing

What this captures. Whether specific value pockets are identified, measured, and framed as reinvention rather than automation.

Your score. Questionnaire-derived score (weighted by question diagnostic value).

Questionnaire signals.

- Q5.1: Has your organization identified specific business processes where AI investment is justified? → 2-3 candidate processes under evaluation (score 50)
- Q5.2: For AI initiatives, what does success look like? → Initiatives have outcome KPIs but ROI attribution is difficult (score 50)
- Q5.3: When considering AI for a business process, how does your organization frame the question? → Primarily: How can AI automate this process more efficiently? (score 35)

Research signals. No external research signals.

Peer comparison. Peer benchmarks are introduced in V0.5+ (placeholder).

What strong looks like. An AI roadmap mapped to sized value pockets with baseline measurement and a reinvention-first frame.

Actions to improve.

- Prioritize 2-3 processes with a real business case
- Set baseline and target outcomes per initiative
- Frame as process reinvention before automation

REGULATORY COMPLEXITY — 72/100 · Established · informational

What this captures. The regulatory and sovereignty constraints that shape which AI patterns are viable (informational).

Your score. 3 framework(s) apply

Questionnaire signals.

- Q6.1: What regulatory frameworks materially apply to your AI use? → EU AI Act (now in force); FCA / PRA AI guidance (UK financial services); FINRA / SEC AI disclosure (US capital markets)
- Q6.2: What data sovereignty or residency requirements constrain AI deployment? → Required in-region data residency; cloud restrictions apply (complexity 20)
- Q6.3: How does your AI strategy address cross-border data flow considerations? → Cross-border flows managed under intragroup agreements; tightening for EU customer data.

Research signals. No external research signals.

Peer comparison. Peer benchmarks are introduced in V0.5+ (placeholder).

What strong looks like. A proactive regulatory posture that turns constraint into a differentiator.

Actions to improve.

- Classify in-flight and planned use cases by risk tier
- Close documentation, human-oversight, and monitoring gaps
- Track applicable frameworks (e.g. EU AI Act) on a horizon scan

SOURCES & ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

Inputs: the prospect's self-reported questionnaire responses, and public research (SEC EDGAR filings and news) where available. This appendix is generated automatically and reviewed by a DXC senior partner before delivery. Confidential — prepared for MeridianFS Holdings, Inc..